

STRATEGIC PARTNERSHIP PROPOSAL · CONFIDENTIAL

AI-Enabled Modernization of Mystery Shopping Operations

A phased strategic roadmap to engineer a next-generation, AI-powered platform for HS Brands - from intelligent mobile data capture to automated quality assurance.

PREPARED FOR

HS Brands

PREPARED BY

Surya Teja : steja@yomsolutions.com
Nishanth : nvonteddu@yomsolutions.com

DATE

March 14, 2026



YOM Solutions

Contents

01	Executive Summary	3
02	Strategic Context & Project Understanding	3
03	Proposed Solution Architecture	4-5
04	Delivery Plan & Timeline	5-7
05	Commercial Investment & Payment Milestones	8
06	Key Assumptions & Exclusions	9

Working Assumptions

This proposal is governed by the following assumptions, refinable during discovery:

- HS Brands does **not currently have an existing shopper app** - the platform will be built from the ground up.
- Admin/client-facing process will be primarily **web/dashboard oriented**
- Shopper-side features: **mobile-first** · Admin features: **web-first**
- Initial rollout: **English-first** with multilingual support in later phases
- Final integration scope may vary depending on hosting setup and data requirements

Executive Summary

HS Brands has a unique opportunity to fundamentally modernize its mystery shopping operations. By transitioning from manual, fragmented data collection to an AI-enabled, mobile-first platform, HS Brands can drastically accelerate turnaround times, enhance data accuracy, and seamlessly scale operations.

Rationale for Modernization: This platform will empower clients with comprehensive experience reports based on a single shopper or all configured shoppers per store (with hour-based tracking), target small business owners through dedicated client app access, and deliver seamless internationalization for clients, shoppers, and service providers.

We recommend a **6-phase agile delivery approach**, spanning approximately **8 months**, with a total fixed investment of **\$120,000 USD**. Our strategic roadmap focuses on four pillars: **shopper submission**, **automated QC**, **cloud AI infrastructure**, and **client onboarding**.

**Final timelines and scope will be committed upon successful completion of the Discovery Phase.*

Target Objectives

- Submission accuracy & Turnaround speed
- Quality control efficiency & Operational scalability
- Client-facing reporting readiness
- **Client Onboarding** improvements
- **Multi-tenant / Globalization** support

Strategic Context & Project Understanding

Current Workflow Stages

1. **Setup** - Survey/questionnaire creation, shopper guidelines
2. **Fieldwork** - Shopper identification, assignment, task completion
3. **Quality Control** - Validation, image review, clarifications
4. **Client Reporting** - Dashboarding, insights delivery

Key Pain Points

- **Inconsistent Data Collection:** Manual entry leads to incomplete or contradictory submissions
- **Delayed Quality Control:** Invalid image uploads or poor responses discovered too late
- **Reporting Bottlenecks:** Manual validation processes delay final insights
- **No Existing App:** Lack of a dedicated platform limits operational efficiency
- **Limited Intelligence:** No AI leveraged to extract insights from voice, images, or unstructured data

Proposed Solution Architecture

YOM Solutions will engineer a proprietary platform structured around four core pillars:

01 The Shopper Application (Mobile-First)

A purpose-built mobile app designed to eliminate friction in the field.

- **Location-Aware Tasking** - Geo-fenced assignment suggestions based on shopper proximity
- **Voice-to-Text Reporting** - Frictionless post-visit surveys powered by conversational AI
- **Smart Submission Engine** - Real-time validation catches missing fields before submission
- **Automated Media Checks** - On-the-fly verification of image quality and relevance
- **Guided Flow + Geo-Verification** - Structured data capture linked to store location

02 HS Features - Task Approvers, QC, Validation

Built to supercharge the QA team and streamline program management.

- **AI-Assisted Quality Control** - Auto-flagging of suspicious or incomplete submissions
- **Smart Review Queues** - Prioritization based on urgency and risk scores
- **Operational Command Center** - Real-time visibility into validation pipelines
- **Report-Readiness Workflow** - Faster determination of client-ready submissions

03 The Cloud AI Foundation

The secure, scalable backend powering the entire ecosystem.

- **Centralized Data Lake** - Secure storage for images, audio, and structured data
- **Backend APIs** - Unified APIs for mobile, admin, and AI modules
- **Enterprise Security** - Role-based access, audit trails, data privacy compliance
- **AI Pipeline** - Modular services for voice-to-text, image validation, routing

04 The Client & Admin Portal

Faster, more reliable access to validated submissions and flexible onboarding.

- **Cleaner Submissions** - Structured data arriving seamlessly from the shopper app
- **Client Onboarding** - Dedicated tenant management for enterprise and small businesses
- **Real-Time Dashboarding** - Enhanced configurable reports and storefront management
- **Report Readiness** - Improved downstream reporting and faster client handoff

Delivery Plan & Timeline

We employ a phased implementation model to deliver measurable value early while minimizing risk.

Phase 1 - Discovery & Technical Blueprint

Understand the current operation, validate assumptions, and define the implementation blueprint.

- Schedule calls with stakeholders and business to understand current process
- Document As-Is flows and process maps
- Define technical approach for AI integration and platform architecture
- Review privacy, governance, and data flow considerations

Deliverables: Discovery summary, As-Is flows, technical blueprint · **Timeline:** 2 weeks

Phase 2 - Shopper App & Submission Modernization

Build the shopper mobile application and modernize how shoppers complete and submit visits.

- Cross-platform mobile app development
- Voice-based post-visit survey flow with AI transcription
- Guided questionnaire UX, image upload workflow, geo-linked task logic
- Submission-time validation engine

Deliverables: Shopper mobile app, voice-enabled survey, smart submission flow · **Timeline:** 13 weeks

Phase 3 - HS Process Improvements

Build the admin/validator dashboard and reduce manual effort through AI-assisted quality control.

- Image validation checks, auto-flagging of incomplete submissions
- Review queue improvements, validation status indicators
- Admin-side submission visibility and report-readiness workflow

Deliverables: Admin dashboard, partial QC automation, faster validation · **Timeline:** 8 weeks

Phase 4 - Client Onboarding & Admin Solutions

Empower clients and small business owners with dedicated access, configuration, and deeper insights.

- Client onboarding changes and tenant provisioning
- Web and App support dedicated for clients
- Enhanced configurable reports · Manage storefronts · Customize questions

Deliverables: Client app/web portal, configurable reporting, onboarding flow · **Timeline:** 5 weeks

Phase 5 - Platform, Cloud & Intelligence

Strengthen backend scalability and add operational intelligence features.

- Backend API enhancements, cloud media/data storage setup
- Role and access management, logging/audit setup
- Location-based task suggestion logic, shopper matching rules
- Groundwork for internationalization and multilingual workflows

Deliverables: Scalable backend, location-based task suggestions, AI pipeline foundation · **Timeline:** 4 weeks

Phase 6 - Testing, Pilot & Stabilization

Validate new workflows in a controlled rollout and refine based on real usage.

- Quality assurance and user acceptance testing
- Pilot rollout with select shoppers and clients
- Bug fixing, hardening, and feedback-driven iteration

Deliverables: Pilot-ready release, stabilized production workflow, rollout recommendations · **Timeline:** 3 weeks

Total estimated timeline: ~35 weeks (~8 months)

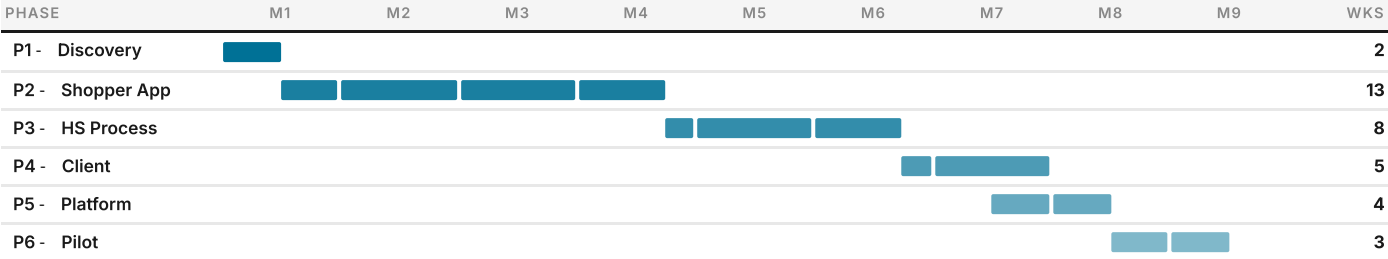
Phases are sequential. Some overlap is possible between phases to accelerate delivery.

Timeline Overview

PHASE	FOCUS	TIMELINE
Phase 1	Discovery & Blueprint	2 weeks
Phase 2	Shopper App & Backend	13 weeks
Phase 3	HS Process Improvements	8 weeks
Phase 4	Client Onboarding	5 weeks
Phase 5	Platform & Intelligence	4 weeks
Phase 6	Pilot & Stabilization	3 weeks
Total		~35 weeks

Phase Delivery Timeline

Visual representation of phase sequencing across the 35-week engagement.



Weeks 1–35. Darker bars represent earlier, higher-investment phases. Lighter bars represent later phases.

SECTION 05

Commercial Investment

The total required investment for the design, development, and deployment of the platform across all 6 phases:

DEVELOPMENT PHASE	FOCUS AREA	ESTIMATED COST (USD)
Phase 1 - Discovery & Blueprint	Architecture, As-Is flows, Planning	\$6,500
Phase 2 - Shopper App & Backend	Mobile app, submission, databases	\$46,000
Phase 3 - HS Process Improvements	Dashboard, AI validation engines	\$26,000
Phase 4 - Client Onboarding	Tenant provisioning, reporting, web/app	\$17,000
Phase 5 - Platform & Intelligence	Routing, global groundwork, APIs	\$14,000
Phase 6 - Pilot & Stabilization	UAT, bug-fixing, deployment	\$10,500
Total Fixed Investment		\$120,000

Final investment depends on integration complexity, AI model tuning, data volume, and hosting requirements confirmed during discovery.

Key Assumptions & Exclusions

Key Assumptions & Dependencies

- **Access:** HS Brands will provide necessary documentation, API specifications, and stakeholder availability during Discovery.
- **Review Windows:** Deliverables require review and sign-off within five (5) business days to prevent timeline slippage.
- **Content:** HS Brands will supply all localized copy, survey questions, shopper guidelines, and operational training content.
- **Environment:** Development and staging environments will be provisioned collaboratively; final production deployment is included.

Out of Scope (Exclusions)

- Monthly cloud infrastructure and hosting costs (e.g., AWS, Azure, Google Cloud)
- Third-party API consumption fees (e.g., OpenAI, mapping services, SMS/email gateways)
- Platform developer account fees (e.g., Apple App Store, Google Play Store)
- Post-launch managed services, SLA-based support, and continued feature development
- Full multi-language translation and region-specific compliance beyond English

Acceptance & Next Steps

1. Review and approve this proposal framework
2. YOM Solutions will issue the Master Services Agreement (MSA) and initial milestone invoice
3. Phase 1 Discovery kickoff to be scheduled within 5 business days of execution



YOM Solutions

info@yomsolutions.com